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Abu Dhabi targets Dh235b in investments

ABU DHABI

BY ABDULLA RASHEED
Abu Dhabi Editor

The Abu Dhabi Department of Economic Development (ADDED) has announced that the emirate aims to attract Dh235 billion in investments across four specialised economic clusters.

The clusters are expected to create 130,000 specialised jobs for highly skilled talent in the innovation economy and contribute more than Dh284 billion to Abu Dhabi's gross domestic product (GDP) by 2045.

The move comes as part of Abu Dhabi's strategy to strengthen its global competitiveness through quality investments, talent attraction, strong partnerships with the private sector and the community, and an innovation-driven economy.

Seamless coordination

Hamid Saiah Al Mazrouei, Undersecretary of ADDED, said that Abu Dhabi's performance reflected clear advances along two complementary tracks: attracting global talent and strengthening investor confidence and the business environment.

On cooperation between ADDED and other government entities to enhance quality of life in Abu Dhabi, Al Mazrouei added that the emirate's operating model was built on seamless government coordination and strong partnerships with the private sector and the community.

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UAE approves Dh292.5 billion federal budget for 2027–2029

THREE-YEAR SPENDING RISES 28.3% COMPARED WITH PREVIOUS PERIOD

DUBAI

Gulf News Report



The UAE Cabinet, chaired by His Highness Sheikh Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, has approved the federal general budget for the years 2027-2029, totalling Dh292.5 billion, reflecting a 28.3 per cent increase compared to the preceding three-year period.

The federal budget for the 2027 fiscal year was approved with estimated total expenditures of Dh90.1 billion, as part of the budget plan for the years 2027-2029.

Sheikh Mohammed said, "Today, we approved the Federal General Budget for 2027 to 2029 with total expenditures of Dh292.5 billion, up 28.3 per cent on the previous three years, and the 2027 budget with expenditures of Dh90.1 billion. Our priorities are fixed and have not changed: education, health, housing, social services, and the quality of life and stability of our citizens. Under the leadership of President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, we will keep consolidating our gains, protecting our achievements and working to build the best life."

Enhancing efficiency

The announced federal budget is part of the ongoing efforts to develop the government financial planning system, as well as enhance efficiency and ensure the sustainability of funding for priority government programmes and projects. Of the 2027 budget, the Cabinet allocated Dh34.6 billion (38.4 per cent) to Social Development and Pensions, Dh29.1 billion (32.3 per cent) to Government Affairs, Dh17.8 billion (19.7 per cent) to Federal Expenses, Dh5.6 billion (6.2 per cent) to Financial Assets and Financial Investments, and Dh3 billion (3.4 per cent) to Infrastructure and Economic Resources.

Main sectors covered by the new federal budget include community protection and safety; the economy of the future; future-oriented education; employment and empowerment; health and quality of life; leadership, government affairs, and international relations; as well as industry, technology, energy, infrastructure, culture, media, and sports.

Long-term planning

The federal general budget for the years 2027-2029 embodies the UAE's commitment to long-term sustainable financial planning, enhancing the efficiency of resource management and directing spending towards the sectors most closely linked to national priorities.

The UAE government approach ensures the continuity of implementation of strategic projects and programmes, and supports the achievement of the country's development, economic and social goals.

The approval of the budget confirms the UAE government's keenness to achieve a balance between current development requirements and investment in future opportunities and to establish a government financial system characterised by flexibility, efficiency and sustainability.

It supports the continuation of the comprehensive development process and enhances the UAE's position among the most advanced and prosperous countries in the world.

Gargash calls for stronger Gulf security and defence cooperation

Attacks on Saudi Arabia threaten UAE and wider Gulf security, he says

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

Dr Anwar Gargash, Diplomatic Adviser to the UAE President, has called for stronger Gulf security and defence cooperation, warning that attacks on Saudi Arabia threaten the UAE and the wider region.

In a post on X, Gargash said recent attacks had exposed the shared threats facing Gulf countries and underscored the need for collective security.

"Since the aggression against the Arab Gulf states began, it has become clear that we are all being targeted and that our security is indivisible," he wrote.

He said the aggressor had mistakenly viewed Gulf states as the weakest link in a conflict they had sought to avoid.

Gargash acknowledged serious shortcomings in Gulf defence cooperation, warning that these had encouraged attacks on the region. "Gulf security is a shared responsibility that allows no room for complacency or delay," he said.

Serious response

Meanwhile, Saudi Energy Minister Prince Abdulaziz Bin Salman warned yesterday that recent attacks demanded a serious response. "The events of recent weeks are serious, our response must be equally serious," he told an energy conference in Riyadh, as oil prices exceeded $105 a barrel.

He said the attacks had tested Saudi Arabia's infrastructure, institutions and resilience.

Saudi authorities extended the suspension of operations at Riyadh's international airport yesterday following repeated Houthi attacks. Strikes in recent days have killed at least 18 people, including 13 on Saturday, with hundreds wounded.

On Sunday, a Pakistani national was killed and 11 others injured when a projectile struck Terminal 4, sparking a fire. It was the fourth reported airport strike in five days. Coalition forces also intercepted a cruise missile near the airport.

— with AFP inputs

SEE ALSO P6

HAMDAN PRAYS FOR SAUDI SECURITY

Sheikh Hamdan Bin Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Crown Prince of Dubai, Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Defence of the UAE and Chairman of the Executive Council of Dubai, shared an image of the Saudi Arabian flag on Sunday and offered a prayer for the kingdom's security amid a series of attacks targeting the country. "My Lord, make this country safe and secure," Sheikh Hamdan wrote alongside the image.

His message came as the UAE reaffirmed its full solidarity with Saudi Arabia and its support for any measures it takes to safeguarding the kingdom's security and stability.

—Khitam Al Amir, Chief News Editor

NATION

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ABU DHABI

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